THE VAULT

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K-Tip Extension Maintenance Guide

Your 3-month removal and reinstallation cycle

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IBE® ELITE ARTIST · OWNER-LED STUDIO · BY APPOINTMENT ONLY

01 · WHERE EVERY SET BEGINS

Your consultation and custom-ordered hair

All new K-Tip clients must come in for a consultation before booking an install. Your hair is custom ordered to match you, so we need to see it first.

K-Tip hair is not pulled from stock. At your consultation, Nicole matches three things in person, in natural light, so your extensions blend seamlessly with your own hair:

Color	Matched at the root, mid-lengths, and ends, including any dimension, highlights, or lived-in tone, so there is no visible line where your hair meets the extensions.
Density	How much hair you naturally have and how much fullness you want. This determines strand count and how the weight is distributed so bonds stay comfortable.
Texture	The thickness of each strand and your natural wave or curl pattern, so the extensions move, style, and air-dry like your own hair.

From consultation to install

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS
1. Book your consultation	Complimentary and required for every new K-Tip client. Arrive with clean, dry, product-free hair and photos of your goal look.
2. Color, density, and texture match	Nicole evaluates your hair, selects the shade, weight, and texture for your custom set, and reviews your 3-month maintenance plan.
3. Quote and deposit	You receive your hair quote and install price. Sign the K-Tip Deposit & Booking Agreement and pay your $1,500 hair deposit (100 g at $15 per gram) to reserve your install and place your order.
4. Custom hair order	Your hair is ordered specifically for you. Once ordered, the K-Tip deposit is non-refundable and non-transferable.
5. Install day	If you are receiving color, it is done first, the same day. Your custom hair is then checked against your own hair one more time before your 3-hour install begins.

Returning clients

If your color, density, or texture has changed since your last set, for example after a new color service or a significant haircut, let us know when booking. We may ask you to come in for a quick re-match before your next custom order.

02 · THE 3-MONTH CYCLE

Why K-Tips are fully removed and reinstalled every 3 months

K-Tips are the one extension method we never "tighten." Every 12 weeks, every bond comes out and new custom hair goes in. This is mandatory, and it is what keeps your natural hair healthy underneath.

Each K-Tip is a small strand of hair joined to your own hair with a heat-fused keratin bond. Because the bond is fixed to your hair (not your scalp), it moves away from the scalp as your hair grows. Past the 3-month mark, three things start to happen:

Tension and twisting	Grown-out bonds swing and pivot on a longer stretch of natural hair, twisting it at the root and adding weight where hair is weakest.
Matting at the bond	Your natural shed hair (50–100 strands a day) collects above each bond. Over time it knots into the new growth and forms mats that can only be cut out.
Breakage and visibility	Bonds become visible when hair moves, and long-wear bonds are harder to remove cleanly, increasing the risk of breakage at removal.

Your 12-week timeline



Hair grows roughly ½ inch per month. By week 12, bonds have migrated far enough to pull, twist, and mat.

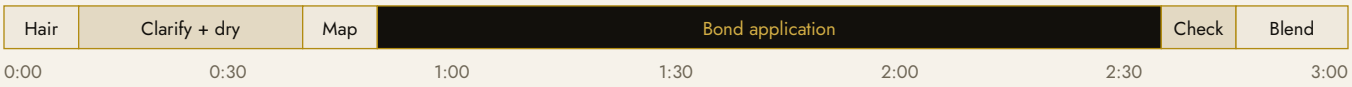
Our 3-month policy

K-Tip clients are booked for full removal and reinstallation no later than 12 weeks after install. Extensions worn past 12 weeks may require additional removal time, detangling, or a consultation before we can reinstall. Please book your next appointment before you leave the salon.

03 · YOUR APPOINTMENT

The 3-hour install, step by step

Here is how your install time is spent. On reinstall visits, removal happens first. If you are receiving color, it is done the same day, after removal and before your install.



TIME	STEP	WHAT HAPPENS
Before	Removal reinstall visits only, ~45–60 min, booked separately	A bond-release solution softens each keratin bond. Your artist gently breaks the bond with removal pliers and slides the strand out, then combs out shed hair that collected above each bond.
Same day	Color if booked, priced separately	Your natural hair is colored after removal and before your install, so the bonds go onto your finished color and your custom hair blends seamlessly.
0:00 – 0:10	Custom hair check	Your custom-ordered hair, matched at your consultation, is checked against your hair in natural light for color, density, and texture. We confirm your length and fullness plan.
0:10 – 0:40	Clarifying shampoo and blowdry	Every new install starts with a clarifying shampoo to strip away oils, conditioner, and product buildup, followed by a full blowdry so your hair is completely clean and dry. This is what lets each keratin bond adhere properly.
0:40 – 0:50	Sectioning and mapping	Your hair is sectioned into clean horizontal rows. Bond placement is mapped to sit at least ½ inch inside your hairline and part so nothing shows, whether your hair is up or down.
0:50 – 2:35	Bond application	Working row by row from the nape upward, a small, even section of your hair is matched to each K-Tip strand. The keratin tip is heated and rolled to seal at least ½ inch to 1 inch away from the scalp, so nothing pulls. Strand count depends on your fullness goal.
2:35 – 2:45	Bond check	Every row is inspected: each bond is tested for grip, its distance from the scalp is confirmed, and we check that no stray hairs are caught between bonds, the first line of defense against matting. Your install should be completely pain-free before you leave the chair.
2:45 – 3:00	Blend cut, style, and home-care review	Your artist cuts the extensions into your natural hair so the ends blend, styles your look, shows you how to brush around the bonds, and books your next removal and reinstall.

Plan for your total visit

First install: about 3 hours. Reinstall visit: about 4 hours including removal. With color: color is done the same day, so plan on an all-day appointment. Every new install includes a clarifying shampoo and blowdry.

What you will feel

Nothing. Your install should be completely pain-free from the moment it is done. If you can feel a bond without touching it, something is wrong; tell your artist before you leave, or call us right away.

04 · BEFORE YOU ARRIVE

Pre-appointment preparation

Keratin bonds grip best on hair that is completely clean and free of product. We clarify and blow-dry your hair in the salon; a few steps at home help your install last the full 12 weeks.

New clients: consultation first	– Every new K-Tip client must come in for a complimentary consultation before booking an install. This is where we match your hair's color, density, and texture. – Your extension hair is then custom ordered to blend seamlessly with your own. Your install date is set once the order is placed.
2–4 weeks before	– Getting color? Tell us at booking. Color is done the same day as your install, after removal and before your new hair goes in, so your custom hair is matched to your finished color. Plan on an all-day appointment; color is priced separately. – Pay your $1,500 hair deposit so your new hair can be ordered. Once hair is ordered, the deposit is non-refundable. – Skip keratin smoothing or deep-conditioning treatments in the two weeks before install; they leave a coating that weakens the bond.
48 hours before	– Stop using oils, serums, dry shampoo, and silicone-based styling products. – Do not apply a hair mask or leave-in conditioner.
Night before or morning of	– No need to wash beforehand. Every new install includes a clarifying shampoo and blowdry in the salon so your bonds adhere properly. – Come with dry hair and skip styling products, oils, and heat protectant the morning of. – If you currently have K-Tips in, brush them out gently as usual; we take care of the removal.
Day of your appointment	– Arrive on time. Arriving 15+ minutes late may shorten or reschedule your service; 30+ minutes late is treated as a no-show, with a $500 fee. – Eat beforehand and bring water, a phone charger, and headphones or a book. You will be in the chair for 3 hours or more. – Bring the same photos of your goal length and fullness you shared at your consultation.

Why every install starts with a clarifying shampoo

Even hair that looks clean carries natural oils, conditioner, and product residue that keep keratin bonds from gripping. Every new install includes a clarifying shampoo and full blowdry at the salon, so your bonds adhere properly from the start.

05 · HOME CARE

Preventing matting between appointments

Almost every mat starts at the bond. Brushing, drying, and how you sleep matter more than any product.

Brushing, 2–3 times a day

- Use a soft loop or extension brush. Hold the hair just below the bonds with one hand to support them.
- Start at the ends and work upward in small sections. Never brush from the root down through tangles.
- Once a day, run your fingers gently between bonds to separate them and release any shed hair caught at the root.

Washing, 2–3 times a week

- Wait 48 hours after your install before the first wash.
- Wash upright in the shower with your head tilted back. Never wash upside down over a sink or tub.
- Use a sulfate-free shampoo. Apply conditioner from mid-lengths to ends only, keeping it away from the bonds.
- Gently squeeze, never rub, the hair dry with a microfiber towel.

Drying, every time

- Blow-dry your roots and bonds completely right after washing. Bonds that stay damp soften and slip.
- Never go to bed with wet or damp hair. This is the single most common cause of matting.

Sleeping, every night

- Brush out, then wear a loose braid or low ponytail with a soft scrunchie.
- Use a silk or satin pillowcase to reduce friction.

Heat and styling

- Use heat protectant every time, and keep irons and wands at least an inch away from the bonds.
- Keep oils, serums, and silicone products to your mid-lengths and ends.

Swimming and workouts

- Braid your hair before you swim or work out. Wet it with fresh water and apply leave-in before you get in the pool; rinse right after.
- Avoid hot tubs and saunas; high heat softens keratin bonds. Dry your roots after a heavy sweat.

CALL THE SALON IF YOU NOTICE	WHY IT MATTERS
Two or more bonds starting to stick together	Caught early, we can separate them in minutes. Left alone, they become a mat.
Any bond you can feel without touching it: pulling, tightness, soreness, or warmth	K-Tips should be completely pain-free. A bond you can feel may be too close to the scalp or holding too much hair, and needs to be checked right away.
A bond slipping or a strand coming loose	Bring the strand with you; do not glue or re-heat it at home.

Your artist will recommend the right brush and home-care products for your hair. Clients receive 20% off stylist-recommended home care at their first extension appointment.

06 · PRICING

Removal vs. reinstall pricing

K-Tips are never moved up. Each 3-month visit has three separately priced parts: removing your current set, installation labor, and the new hair custom ordered for you.

REMOVAL

$65

Full removal of your current K-Tips, every 3 months.

INSTALL LABOR

$375–$500

Per hour at your artist's rate. A typical install is about 3 hours.

CUSTOM HAIR

$15/gram

Charged for the full amount ordered. A typical set is 100 g.

Typical reinstall visit, by artist

SERVICE	NICOLE STRACHAN	OLIVIA MARTIN
Removal of current set	$65	$65
Install labor (about 3 hours)	$1,500 ($500/hr)	$1,125 ($375/hr)
New custom hair (100 g at $15/g)	$1,500	$1,500
Typical reinstall visit total	$3,065	$2,690
First install (no removal)	$3,000	$2,625

How hair weight changes your total

HAIR ORDERED	HAIR COST	TOTAL WITH NICOLE	TOTAL WITH OLIVIA
90 g	$1,350	$2,850	$2,475
100 g	$1,500	$3,000	$2,625
110 g	$1,650	$3,150	$2,775

Totals above include hair and 3 hours of labor, before removal. Your final quote is set at your consultation and depends on the grams ordered and the time required. If you are receiving a color service, it is done the same day as your install, making it an all-day appointment; color is priced separately.

Pricing from The Vault's K-Tip Extension Deposit & Booking Agreement and service menu.

06 · PRICING, CONTINUED

Your $1,500 hair deposit

Because your hair is custom ordered and color matched for you, it cannot be returned or resold. The deposit is what places your order.

$1,500 = 100 grams × $15 per gram

Due at booking, and again any time new hair needs to be ordered, including each 3-month reinstall. Your appointment is not confirmed and hair is not ordered until the deposit is paid. The deposit is credited to your total on the day of service.

IF YOUR ORDER IS	WHAT HAPPENS
Exactly 100 g	Your deposit covers your hair in full. You pay labor (and removal, on reinstall visits) at your appointment.
More than 100 g	The extra hair ($15 per gram over 100 g) is due at your install appointment.
Less than 100 g	The unused part of your deposit is credited toward your labor.
Not fully installed	Any hair from your order that is not installed is yours to take home.

The deposit is non-refundable once hair has been ordered. A credit card must be kept on file at The Vault to book and hold every appointment.

Cancellations, rescheduling, and no-shows

SITUATION	WHAT HAPPENS
Reschedule with 7+ days' notice	Your deposit transfers to the new date. One reschedule is allowed; any further change is treated as a late cancellation.
Reschedule or cancel with less than 7 days' notice	$500 fee charged to your card on file, unless The Vault is able to fill your appointment time. The deposit is non-refundable and does not transfer; your hair is yours to pick up or bring to a new appointment.
No-show	$500 fee charged to your card on file. The deposit is non-refundable and does not transfer; your hair is yours to pick up or bring to a new appointment.
Arriving 15+ minutes late	Your service may be shortened or rescheduled. Arriving 30+ minutes late is treated as a no-show, including the $500 fee.
Salon must reschedule	Your deposit transfers in full to a new date.

Hair pickup

Hair ordered for you belongs to you. If you cancel and do not rebook, you have 30 days from the cancellation date to pick it up. Hair not picked up within 30 days becomes part of The Vault's overstock, and the deposit is not refunded. The $500 late-cancellation fee is separate from your deposit.

Full terms are in the K-Tip Extension Deposit & Booking Agreement, which must be signed before hair is ordered.

07 · BOOKING PLANNER

Book your next appointment

Fill this in with your artist before you leave, or type into the fields on screen. Your reinstall date is 12 weeks after today's install.

Client details

CLIENT NAME

PHONE

EXTENSION ARTIST

CONSULTATION DATE

CUSTOM HAIR: COLOR / DENSITY / TEXTURE

EMAIL

This cycle

INSTALL DATE (WEEK 0)

MID-CYCLE VISIT (WEEK 6)

NEW HAIR ORDERED, GRAMS (WK 9)

REMOVAL + REINSTALL (WEEK 12)

REINSTALL TIME

$1,500 DEPOSIT PAID / DATE

SAME-DAY COLOR? / ADD-ONS BOOKED

12-month plan

VISIT	TARGET WEEK	DATE	TIME	ARTIST	BOOKED
Install / reinstall 1	Week 0				☐
Reinstall 2	Week 12				☐
Reinstall 3	Week 24				☐
Reinstall 4	Week 36				☐
Reinstall 5	Week 48				☐

Before you leave today

- ☐ Next removal + reinstall booked (no later than week 12)
- ☐ Agreement signed, card on file, deposit paid
- ☐ Home-care products and extension brush
- ☐ Reviewed brushing, washing, and sleep routine

Book online through GlossGenius, call or text (203) 228-5027, or ask at the front desk.

Changes and cancellations can be made by phone, text, or through GlossGenius. Hours: Tue, Wed, Fri 9–5 · Thu 10–8 · Sat 8–1 · Closed Sun and Mon.